knowledge (a former Stasi Major involved asserted Honecker ‘most certainly’ knew).11

Interestingly, Bettina Röhl, the daughter of Urlike Meinhof – one of the leaders of the RAF – says that even in the 60s, Erich Honecker arranged secret funding for her parents’ avant-garde leftist magazine Konkret, published in West Germany. According to Rohl, the contents and character of the magazine were so important, that Honecker injected funds equating to the equivalent of 20,000 euros from GDR coffers to finance each issue.

With the fall of the Berlin Wall in 1989, it was revealed that twenty-four secret meetings between the MfS and RAF took place in the period 1978–84. RAF cadres were able to enter the GDR at practically any time, also after deadly attacks were committed in the West.12 There are numerous interpretations of why the SED welcomed terrorists with open arms. In 1990, Hans Ludwig Zachert, the president of the FRG Federal Office of Investigation, provided several theories.

Some people say that there were the ‘early experiences’ of Mielke and Honecker – that is, sympathy for these desperadoes – which is a sentimental interpretation that is hard to believe. Another says that East Berlin believed it would get information on the plans of international terrorism, and that in the FRG, from the persons concerned. In addition, there is the idea of secretly leading the ‘class enemy’ up the garden path, and I think the SED leaders are capable of so much wickedness that the aspect that all this can be turned into money might have also played a role. Maybe an idea like that of the ransoming of agents prevailed – that is, extradition against payment.

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